

Throwbacks. Throwbacks occur twice every three patterns. When they do occur, it takes 12 days on average for the stock to return to the breakout price. However, the appearance of a throwback hurts performance. I guess it's like having ants on your food at a picnic. Joy turns to disappointment. After a throwback completes, the uptrend resumes most often, so don't panic-sell during a throwback.

Gaps. If price gaps upward on the day of breakout, it suggests better performance. Because I measure performance using the opening price the day *after* the gap, you can buy the stock and still hope to participate in the better performance.

[Table 28.5](#) shows pattern size statistics.

Height. Many chart pattern types have tall patterns outperforming short ones, and that's what we see here. In fact, the performance difference between short and tall patterns is quite large.

For a trading advantage, measure the height of the pattern from the tallest peak (between the two bottoms) to the lower of the two bottoms and divide by the price of the tallest peak. If the result is higher than the median shown in the table, then you have a tall pattern.

With such a large performance difference, it's worth taking the time to check if your double bottom is tall and avoid trading short ones unless there's a compelling reason for doing so.